

SENTENCE

It is a word or group of words that expresses a complete thought. It must have a subject and a predicate. The subject is that part of the sentence about which something is being said.

TYPES OF SENTENCE

1. IMPERATIVE SENTENCE: It is a command

- a. Sit down!
- b. Get out that room.
- c. Sit down and keep quiet.
- d. Stop making noise and listen attentively.

2. DECLARATIVE SENTENCE: This is a statement e.g.

- a. Ladi closed the door.
- b. The police arrested the man.
- c. Musa is cleaning the house.
- d. The earth moves round the sun.

3. EXCLAMATORY SENTENCE: It is a sentence expressing emotion and strong feelings.

- a. What a shame!
- b. What a beautiful car this is!
- c. Here comes the Rector of the polytechnic.
- d. Wow! What a beautiful day.

4. INTERROGATIVE SENTENCE: It deals with question e.g.

- a. Where is your house?
- b. When are you coming?
- c. How was the test?
- d. Did you post the letter?

TYPES OF SENTENCE ACCORDING TO STRUCTURE

1. SIMPLE SENTENCE: It is the type of sentence that contains one subject and one predicate or one main clause e.g.

- a. Birds fly.
- b. We are in the classroom.
- c. Nigeria is a country.
- d. My father is a lawyer

2. COMPOUND SENTENCE: This type of sentence contains two or more main clauses that are joined by a coordinating conjunction e.g

- a. We are in the classroom and we are studying English language

- b. Kate is teacher and her sister is a lawyer.
 - c. I greeted the man but he did not answer me.
 - d. you can see me now or you can see me after meeting.
3. **COMPLEX SENTENCE:** This is a type of sentence that contains one main clause and one or more subordinate clauses e.g.
- a. I warned her but she will not listen.
 - b. The Lady is in the hospital because she is ill.
 - c. Nigeria is a country which has many mineral resources.
 - d. The man who came here yesterday is a friend.
4. **COMPOUND COMPLEX SENTENCE:** It is a type of sentence that has two or more main clauses and one or more subordinate clauses. E.g.
- a. Ahmadu came in the morning and told us that he was successful in the interview but that his scores were low.
 - b. I love you and I want to marry you but you have to love me also because love should be reciprocal.
 - c. Before I opened the bureau I was a social worker, but I was frustrated because I always wanted to do more for my clients than I could.
 - d. Since Emeka married his second wife, his children have not enjoyed good health and he has lost his peace of mind.

PARTS OF A SENTENCE

1. THE SUBJECT

The subject is the person or thing talked about in the sentence, i.e is the main actor. The most important part of the subject is the headwork. Of all the words that make up the subject, the headwork is the only word which cannot be replaced, and it determines whether a sentence is singular plural.

2. PREDICATE

The predicate, on the other hand, comprises what is said about the subject. It is usually made up of words that belong to any of the seven parts of speech.

The most important part of the predicate is the verb.

<u>SUBJECTS</u>	<u>PREDICATE</u>
● Children	Cry often
● Our examinations	Were completed on schedule
● The use of language	Distinguishes human beings from animals

● Drunkards	Babble a lot of nonsense
● Bukola	Is very beautiful
● He	Went to Abuja yesterday
● The sun	Rises in the east
Ibadan	Is my birth place .

TENSES

Tense is a form of verb that shows time in which an act, state or condition occurs or occurred. There are basically three tenses in English:

- i. Present tense
- ii. Past tense
- iii. Future tense.

Any unnecessary shift from one tense to another in a single utterance or sentence should be avoided

PRESENT TENSE

Present tense is used to denote, signify or refer to activities taking place now, always or eternal truth. e.g.

- I am reading my notes.
- Musa is a student.
- He speaks loudly.
- The sun rises from the east.

Present tense is of three types, present simple, present perfect and present continues.

1. Present Simple Tense

Present simple tense is used for actions performed as a matter of habit, „always and eternal truth. e.g.

1. He speaks loudly.
2. Bala is good man.
3. James goes to school late.
4. The sun rises from the east.
5. They are not helping matters.
6. Get out of my way!
7. What is your name?
8. What a mess!
9. Will you please help me with some money?
- 10.I suggest you buy the red dress.

Present simple tense performs any one of these function: declaration, imperative, exclamation, interrogation, suggestion, requests, wish and probability (as indicated above) Proverbs and idioms are also said in present simple tense, e.g.

- i. A stich in time saves nine
- ii. Empty vessels make the loudest noise.

At times present simple tense is also used for planned future e.g. the president leaves to London tomorrow.

2. Present Perfect Tense

This tense is used for action that are completed but not too long and have relevance in the present or future; it is also used along with HAVE or HAS plus the participle sense of the verb e.g. .

- i. I have seen him.
- ii. He has seen me.
- iii. They have eaten all the food.
- iv. She has done the work.
- v. Musa has finish his test. .
- vi. The thief broken the door's handle.
- vii. She has done the homework.
- viii. The assignment has been completed.
- ix. We have not eaten for two days now. .

3. Present Continuous Tense

This continuous tense is used for action or activities yet to be completed (that is ongoing actions) or activities. It is also used for planned actions on arranged future. E.g.

- i. He is cooking food. .
- ii. They are writing the second paper.
- iii. He is lecturing.
- iv. I am going tomorrow.
- v. They are coming for celebration.
- vi. We are keeping him in custody for two days

2. Past Tense

Past tense is generally used for actions or activities that are performed and completed in the past. Past tense, like present tense, is of three types: past simple, past perfect and past continuous tense. They are:

1. Past Simple Tense

This is used for actions or activities that took place in the past e.g.

- i. He did the assignment — yesterday.
- ii. We slept well.
- iii. He knocked him down.
- iv. They demanded money from me.

Past simple tense is used for "WISHING VERB" e.g.

- i. I wish I were in your shoes.
- ii. How I wish he was not there.
- iii. We wish were gave us the money in time.
- iv. It is also used in constructions as:
 - i. It is high time I mastered English.
 - ii. It is high time I Went there.
 - iii. It is high time he washed his clothes.

2. Past Perfect Tense

This tense is used to refer to an action or activity that took place at point in time before now and completed a long time ago. A past perfect tense is used along with HAD and the participle sense of the verb e.g.

1. I had seen him before he noticed it.
2. We had gone there for two hours before demanded for our papers.

3. Past Continuous Tense: This is used to indicate action (s) that started in the past and yet to be completed and it is usually accompanied with past simple tense or when two activities happened or took place in the past simultaneously while one is shorter than the other. The longer action (s) takes past continuous and "ing" sense of the verb and the shorter action takes the past simple tense e.g.

- i. I was reading when he arrived.
- ii. We were watching television when the incident happened.
- iii. I was going for my lectures when I met him.

3. Future Tense:

This is used for actions or state of being that one expected to take place in the future. Future tense like the rest of the tenses is of three types: future simple, future perfect, and future continuous tense.

1. Future Simple Tense.

This is used for intended action (s) e.g.

- i. Will go home tomorrow.
- ii. They will write exams next week.
- iii. She will do it herself.

2. Future Perfect Tense

This is used for action intended to be completed in the future e.g.

- i. I will have eaten my food by 9:00am
- ii. They will have taken the exams by now tomorrow.
- iii. We would have finished the work by next week Friday.

Future perfect tense like the present and past perfect tenses has its verb in the participle sense e.g. eaten, taken, seen, finishes, laughed etc.

Future Continuous. Tense

This is used for planned or arranged action or activity in the future e.g.

- i. I will be sweeping my room in an hour's time I will be going for lectures. tomorrow
- ii. They will be registering students as they come.

While future simple tense is for intended actions, generally, future continuous is for planned action just as present continuous and present simple tense.

CONCORD

Concord means agreement. The parts of a sentence (subject and verb) must agree. If the subject is singular, the verb is singular (agreement in number); if the noun is masculine, the pronoun referring to the noun should also be masculine

(agreement in gender); and if the subject is in the first person, the verb should be in the first person (agreement in person). Osasona and Onjjewu (2007) defines concord as the art of uniting the major elements in a sentence which are the subject and the verb to achieve balance and meaning in the expression e.g.

- i. Houses in independent layout are expensive
- ii. A house in Mubi is inexpensive
- iii. They do their work diligently
- iv. She does her job carelessly

Types of Concord

1. Grammatical Concord: this refers to the agreement of a subject and a verb based on the grammatical number of the subject. e.g.
 - i. Everybody has gone home.
 - ii. Each man, woman and child is here.
2. Notional Concord: this is the agreement of a subject and a possessive adjective bearing in mind the idea of numbers behind the subject e.g.
 - i. Everyone must do their homework
 - ii. Everybody is here.
3. Proximity Concord: proximity means nearness. The verb is attracted to whichever subject that is nearest to it e.g.
 - i. These sorts of things are good
 - ii. Neither of them has done it.

Rules of Concord

1. Subject verb agreement in number: singular subjects take singular verbs while plural subjects take plural verbs. e.g.
 - i. A book is a treasure
 - ii. Books are treasure.

But when two subjects refer to one entity, that subject takes a singular verb e.g.

- i. Rice and plantain is my favorite meal.
 - ii. My wife and mother of my children is Fumi.
2. Subject- object concord: this type of concord addresses the fact that the reflexive pronoun should match the subject, number and gender. e.g.
 - i. John has taught himself a new trick
 - ii. Martha bought herself a new bag
 - iii. They are working for themselves.
3. Noun pronoun agreement: when a pronoun stands in place of a noun, that noun is the antecedent of the pronoun. Since the pronoun refers to the noun in a sentence, the pronoun agrees with its antecedent in number and gender. e.g.,

- i. Okonkwo caught up with the wolves and killed them.
- ii. Mary bought a car with her life savings.
- Ili. Each of these ministries submitted its account for audit.
- iv. Neither the letter nor the parcels have reached their destination

ESSAY WRITING

An essay can be defined as a logical piece of writing in prose form. It usually expresses the day to day human experiences, desires, feelings, ideas, thoughts and opinions. It is a short piece of writing by a student as part of a course of study. It can also be referred to as a piece of writing on a particular subject written in order to be published. It has its own rules which are grammar, spelling and punctuation.

TYPES OF ESSAY

1. **NARRATIVE ESSAY:** is a straight forward account of real or imagined events or incidents. It is an essay that narrates an event or recreates a story that happened in the past.

Labov (1972) defines narrative essay as one method of recapulating past experience by matching a verbal sequence of events which actually occurred. Suitable topics are:

- How I spend my holiday
- My first day in the university
- A visit to a notable. Site
- The visit to the president to my village
- A dream I cannot forget
- My first flight
- My visit to the hospital etc.

In this type of essay, one is expected to view the incident and make it look real that is it actually took place. The tense is usually in the past. It should be presented in a way that it leaves the reader with a clear mental picture.

2. **DESCRIPTIVE ESSAY:** it deals with the picturing in words of persons, scenes, events and objects of any kinds. Although, there is no underlying story to hold on to in descriptive composition, but there must be a central idea to which everything you describe will revolve around. It is a record of observed facts; in facts it is a drawing in words. Below are some topics:

- A rainy day
- A village thunderstorm
- My favorite artist/musician or player o A street scene
- My cynosure

3. ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY.

When you develop persuasive essays, you may try to anticipate possible arguments against your position and offer counter arguments. This type of rebuttal in advance is called arguing by refutation because you are supporting the thesis of your essay

by refuting the contrary position. The main concern of argumentative essay is to effectively present one's opinion in order to persuade the reader to dance to one's point of view. One may be asked to either argue for or against a topic. The topics are usually debatable in nature and one will be required to convince the reader.

Examples:

- A teacher is better than a doctor
- Private schools are better than public schools
- A doctor should be useful in the society than a farmer
- Is science an enemy of mankind?
- Co-educational institutions are a curse to the nation Nigeria
- Should women education be scrapped?
- The case for or against capital punishment

4. EXPOSITORY ESSAY

It is used in the broad sense to include all prose writing that is not fiction. In other words, it narrates, describes, argues and explains an idea or concept of a process or a device. An expository essay therefore, is that type of essay where all what is said about different types of essay are put together to constitute a unified whole. The writer here, shows his capability for logical thought and reasoning. It is a factual essay and oftentimes makes judgment usually written in the simple present tense. Examples of suitable topics are:

- How to make bread
- A day in the life of a goldsmith
- My ambition in life
- The Role of English Language in Nigeria

QUALITIES OF A GOOD ESSAY

A good essay possesses the following qualities:

- UNITY:** Unity means singleness or oneness of purpose. Unity means that all the sentences contained in an essay must revolve around a single idea.
- COHERENCE:** A good essay is coherent. An essay is coherent when the thoughts expressed in each sentence are ordered and the thought of each sentence is logically related to the thought contained in the next paragraph.
- CLARITY:** Clarity demands that sentences in an essay be so vividly expressed that, the ideas are clear to the reader. An essay is devoid of clarity when the sentences that make it up are subject to two meanings, sentences are capable of two interpretations, when the modifiers are misplaced, dangling or squinting and when the comparisons are illogical. That is to say sentences must be devoid of ambiguity.

- iv. **COMPLETENESS:** Your essay is complete when, within the required space of twelve to fifteen lines you present enough detail to satisfy your reader.
- v. **LEGIBILITY:** Legibility means the essay must be readable that is the handwriting must be
- vi. **SIMPLICITY:** Simplicity means your essay must be presented in a simple language to the understating of your reader.

FEATURES OF AN ESSAY

Like most writing discourse, an essay has three major divisions or parts. These include:-

- a. The introduction
- b. The body
- c. The conclusion

INTRODUCTION

This is the beginning paragraph(s) of an essay and it performs various functions.

Among the functions are:-

- a. To introduce the subject of discourse
- b. To arouse interest of the reader
- c. To define the subject matter
- d. To set focus of discussion
- e. To establish the manner and site in which the subject matter or the whole essay will be dealt with.
- f. To introduce the point of view of the writer and
- g. To summarize the essay

One paragraph could serve as an introduction, however, in longer essays or projects or reports, a whole chapter can be an introduction. Introduction is supposed to be written in a clear and precise manner.

THE BODY

The body consists of the major contents of the essay. It deals with issues to be discussed. Essays are planned in to paragraphs; each paragraph consists of major idea. While writing the main body of an essay certain things need to be considered or taken care of e.g.

- i. Accuracy of information
- ii. Sentence coordination
- iii. Maintenance of high level of mechanical accuracy, thus spelling, punctuation, tense etc
- iv. Formally, correct and standard & forms of words

CONCLUSION

This is usually the last paragraph; it brings the essay to a final stop. A concluding paragraph sums-up what has already been said in the foregone paragraph.

LOGIC AND LOGICAL THINKING

Leilis (1975) States that logic is the science of reasoning...The process of drawing a conclusion from evidence or what one takes to be evidence.

1. Kilgore (1968) Sees logic as a critical analysis and development of the structure of reliable inference.
2. Copi (1971) Says that the study of logic is study of the method and principles used in distinguishing correct reasoning.

All those definitions suggest that logic essentially aims at explaining the difference between correct reasoning.

THE PURPOSE OF LOGIC

- i. When we study logic, our abilities to reason correctly is enhanced.
- ii. The purpose of logic is to enable us take good and sound decisions.
- iii. It enables us to understand errors in reasoning by affording us the tools to analyze arguments.
- iv. It enables us to overcome irrational thinking, parochialism and obsession.
- v. It enables us to reason in an orderly manner.

PRINCIPLES OF LOGIC

1. Argument: It refers to the attempt to bring evidence in support of a conclusion. Mayfield (1987). Defines arguments as a principal of logic a body of discourse that present evidence in support of some thesis. An argument has two (2) Components:

- a. conclusion is a statement made about an argument which has been supported by evidence. It is drawn or inferred on the Premise. eg. If all gold does rust but Bello's wristwatch rusts then that wristwatch is not gold.
 - b. Premise: This is a statement that formulates evidence. It asserts grounds or gives reasons/evidence used in support of a conclusion. Premise is formed in such a way that it neither denies nor affirms e.g. when somebody Says that: "it will soon rain the might have notice that the sky is cloudy
2. Proposition or assertion: This is when a statement is made without any attempt to substantiate the claim. That is anything said without a proof or evidence.
3. Opinion: It is a personal subjective judgment based on what one believes to be true or false. E.g. there are many students who are very lazy.

4. Fact: Anything that is known to be the truth is a fact. It is something that is universally accepted and very obvious to all. It is often used in support of proposition because of its reliability. A fact cannot be argued, it can only be verified or cross-checked at the primary source e.g. Nigeria is a country.
5. Assumption: This is an opinion taken to be true even though one is not sure or may not ever be sure about it. In other words, it is something that is believed without careful checking.
6. Inference: This is a process of reaching conclusion. It is a psychological activity of reaching an opinion from accepted evidences or premises. It is the mental process of moving from premise to conclusion.
7. Syllogism: This is a form of reasoning in which conclusion is reached from two (2) statements.

METHODS OF REASONING

i. DEDUCTIVE: Deductive logic is reasoning from the general to the particular or individual. It is an argument in which the premises do not necessarily imply or entails the conclusion. The premises rather constitute Conclusive evidence for the conclusion. This deductive reasoning is the process by which we reach a specific conclusion. This deductive reasoning is the one in which we reach a specific conclusion rather than a general one. e.g.

1. All mammals breast feed their young ones
2. Cows are mammals
3. Therefore, cows' breast feed their young ones.

In this type of argument, conclusion is derived from the premises that are at least implied or actually stated.

ii. INDUCTIVE METHOD: Inductive is an instance of reasoning from individual or particular phenomenon to general conclusion. An inductive argument is one in which the premises do not necessarily imply the conclusion. It is the means of obtaining Knowledge of the general from Knowledge of the individual. Inductive logic therefore consists of observing and mentally organizing data and then making a generalization about the data. The reasoning process is based on experience and it implies learning experience. E.g.

1. Mubi is in Adamawa State
2. Adamawa State is in Nigeria.
3. Mubi; Therefore is in Nigeria.

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LITERATURE

Literature refers to a class of writing in which imaginative expressions, aesthetic form, universality of ideas and permanence are its characteristics.

Genres of Literature

This refers to the major divisions or components of literature namely:

1. **Prose:** this refers to any writing that is written in paragraphs and chapters.
E.g. short story, Essays, Novel, Biography, Autobiography etc.
2. **Drama:** this refers to a literary composition either in verse or prose that tells a story through action and speech. E.g. Tragedy, Comedy, Satire, Melodrama etc.
3. **Poetry:** this is a superior form of creation written in verses and stanzas which can be taken to cover any kind of metrical composition. E.g. Ode, Sonnet, Lyric, Dirge etc,

Functions of Literature

- i. Entertainment
- ii. Education
- iii. Information
- iv. Didactic
- v. Store house of cultural material

Types of Poetry

1. Lyric: it is a short and simple poem written to express personal emotion and feeling. It is a witty poem that expresses the theme of love.
2. Dirge: it is poem of lamentation thus sorrow.
3. Satire: is a poem written to lampoon the society, institutions, government, individuals etc.
4. Epic: this refers to a long narrative poem which tells of heroes and heroic deeds usually of high significance to the nation involved and embodying its early history or tradition. Poem written for praise.
5. Ode: it is a poem written for special occasion. It's usually takes the form of an adoration paid in a dignified manner.

6. Elegy: it is a solemn poem of lamentation written to mourn the death.
The content is usually melancholic.
7. Sonnet: this refers to any poem of fourteen (14) lines.
8. Eulogy: it is a song of praise in honour of royalty, human beings, animals, objects etc. In this type of poem, the singer extols the virtues of the subject.

Terminologies of Poetry

1. Verse: writing that is arranged in lines often with a regular rhythm or pattern of rhyme.
2. Theme: this is the central idea of the poetry.
3. Rhyme: similarities of sound at the end of a line in a poem.
4. Stanza: this refers to division in poetry.